



A NEW TASTE

Indian brands are increasingly foregrounding sourcing, drawing on beans from Chikkamagaluru, Kodagu, and the Western Ghats

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compared to imports.” But beyond that, he says, quality has really improved. “Bartenders now have a strong local alternative that can match—or even outperform—global options in certain applications. So, it’s both a creative and a commercial decision.”

Quaffine, which is produced in Goa, has expanded from there to multiple Indian cities including Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Pune, Bengaluru and international markets such as Thailand and Kenya. In 2024, Diageo bought a 25% stake in Quaffine. Pereira says since then the brand has grown 2.5 times. He is bullish and expects production

to double this year. “From the current 3 tonnes of coffee, we will need 6 tonnes this year.” It’s a far cry from the time when shopkeepers in Goa questioned why anyone would pay ₹1,650 for an Indian brand. “I didn’t understand that since you don’t pay for origin, only for quality,” smiles Pereira, happy to have been proven right.

Bandarful, meanwhile, has been focussing on building a strong presence in the right markets. It has grown from a few initial regions to cities like Delhi, Gurugram, Goa, Bengaluru, Mumbai, Pune, Pondicherry, and Uttarakhand. There’s also early international movement

in markets like the US, UK, West Asia, and Italy, where there is strong interest in craft, origin-led spirits. It was recently named the World’s Best Liqueur at the 2025 USA Spirits Ratings, adding to its international recognition.

While commercially, the category remains extremely small, with Pereira slotting it at less than 1% of the alco-bev market, it is likely to expand through the decade, thanks to urban consumers, rising disposable incomes, and a willingness to experiment.

Little wonder, India’s coffee liqueur story is still being written, one pour at a time! **BT**